

Altadena — Quick Talking Points

What to say. Keep it simple. For everyone in our community. Advocacy material, not legal advice.

The situation

After the Eaton Fire, speculators are using a state law — **SB 1123** — to subdivide burned lots into **up to 10 units each, by right, with no public hearing**. At least **10 are already on the County's books**. After the same fire, the Palisades got an emergency order — but it was tied to a **fire-hazard map that left most of Altadena out**. We got a **hand-me-down, not a protection written for us**.

Why this is everyone's fight

- Our whole community is still recovering — rebuilding, remediating, fighting insurers. Piling speculative development on top of that is one more burden Altadena shouldn't have to carry.
- It changes the **whole neighborhood**, not just the lots that burned: evacuation safety on our narrow streets, strain on our sewers, septic, water, and roads, and the character of the community we all chose.
- **Out-of-town speculators are reshaping the town block by block** — turning a recovery into a land rush while families are still displaced.
- **We won't be coming home to the same community**. If our neighborhoods come back dotted with speculative development that preyed on desperate neighbors, the Altadena we left isn't the one we return to — and once that character is gone, it's gone.

Our three asks

1. **An emergency order from the Governor — now**. Protect the **whole declared disaster area, not the hazard map** — covering both SB 9 and SB 1123. Supervisor Barger, Asm. Harabedian, and Sen. Pérez should all press the Governor.
2. **Pass and strengthen SB 1090** so it protects us from the fire date forward.
3. **Carve Altadena out of SB 1116**. We're not blocking housing statewide — just exempting our disaster area while we rebuild.

Why the emergency order matters most — and why we can't just wait for SB 1090

- **The Governor's emergency order is the only tool that can act now and reach back.** It can halt the projects already in the pipeline — the ten-plus subdivisions already filed, and the Certificates of Compliance racing to lock in rights — before they're finalized. That's "**look-back**" **protection** for the harm already underway.
- **SB 1090 is still pending — it may not pass.** It's a bill, not yet law, and its fate is uncertain.
- **Even if SB 1090 passes, it may only protect going forward.** Depending on its final text and effective date, it could apply only to *future* projects ("look-forward") and might not stop the ones already filed. That's the gap.
- **So we need both:** the emergency order *now* for immediate, look-back protection — **and** SB 1090 strengthened to run from the fire date (Jan 7, 2025) and cover any project without an issued building permit, so nothing already in motion slips through. (*Projects that have already vested may be beyond reach — which is exactly why acting now matters.*)

If you speak at the Town Council (≈2 minutes)

"I'm an Altadena resident. **[Your story — what the fire and its aftermath have meant for you and your family.]** Speculators are using SB 1123 to carve our burned lots into up to ten units each, with no public hearing — at least ten projects are already filed. The Palisades got an emergency order; we got a hand-me-down tied to a fire-hazard map that left most of Altadena out. Our community is still recovering, and this piles one more burden on people already stretched thin. I'm asking our officials to get the Governor to protect the whole disaster area now, to pass and strengthen SB 1090, and to carve Altadena out of SB 1116. A lot split can't be undone. Please act before it's too late."

If you call or email, say:

- Speculators are using SB 1123 to subdivide burned Altadena lots into up to 10 units with no hearing — and it reshapes the whole neighborhood, our evacuation safety, and our infrastructure.
- Protect the **whole disaster area, not the hazard map** that left most of Altadena out — cover SB 9 and SB 1123.
- Pass and strengthen SB 1090, and carve Altadena out of SB 1116.

Who to contact

- **Supervisor Kathryn Barger** — (626) 792-1886 · Kathryn@bos.lacounty.gov
- **Gov. Gavin Newsom** — (916) 445-2841 · gavin.newsom@gov.ca.gov
- **Sen. Sasha Renée Pérez** — (626) 304-1086 · Edmundo.Cuevas@sen.ca.gov
- **Asm. John Harabedian** — (626) 351-1917 ·
assemblymember.harabedian@assembly.ca.gov

Take action online (one click emails everyone): <https://altadenarecoverywatch.github.io/SaveAltadena/>

Altadena Recovery Watch · a fair recovery, not a fire sale · not legal advice.